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The PHILATEX

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MEETING CALENDAR 2022

JULY			AUGUST		
1	NO MEETING - July 4th Weekend		5	BOG & Meeting "Show & Tell"	7:00 pm 7:30 pm
8	BOG & Meeting "Show & Tell"	7:00 pm 7:30 pm	12	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30-no lots after 7:15)	7:30 pm
15	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:15)	7:30 pm	19	Bourse & Bags – buy, sell & trade, & Bag Night! (set-up at 6:30 pm)	6:30 pm
22	Program-What do we have stamps for if we aren't using them on mail? by Fred Groth	7:30 pm	26	NO MEETING - END OF SUMMER	
29	Bourse & Bags - buy, sell & trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	6:30 pm			
Sept: 02-NO MEETING-Labor Day; 09-Show&Tell; 16-Auction 23-Program 30-Bourse & Bags;					

EDITOR'S CORNER

US #1094 was issued on July 4th in 1957. US #1132 was issued on July 4 in 1959.

On July 4, 1957, the US Post Office issued its first stamp with the US flag as the central design Previously, the US flag had appeared as a part of the design of several stamps, such as the Eagle and Shield Pictorial, the Francis Scott Key stamp, and the 1952 Lafayette issue. In 1957, the US Post Office announced that it would issue a brand new stamp with the flag as the central design and appearing in its natural colors.

Upon hearing the news, some collectors and citizens were outraged. Because the stamps would be canceled, they saw it as disrespectful. They flooded the post office with angry letters citing American legal code that prohibited the reproduction of "the national emblem for disloyal or commercial purposes." Conversely, many people were also happy about the stamp, praising its beautiful colors and patriotic design. The Post Office stated the stamp was meant to be a reminder of America's heritage and hard-won liberty. In spite of the controversy, the stamp was issued as planned on July 4, 1957, in Washington, DC.

Exactly two years after this stamp was issued, the Post Office issued another flag stamp, #1132. The new stamp featured a flag with 49 stars, to mark the day the 49-star flag went into use. That was a rule dating back to 1818 that declared stars representing new states added to the Union would be added to the flag on the first July 4 after the state joined the Union. This stamp was issued in Auburn, New York, home of William H. Seward, who had arranged the purchase of Alaska (the 49th state whose star was added in 1959).

One year later, the US flag was again the central focus of a new stamp issued on Independence Day. This stamp, #1153, pictured the new 50-star flag and was issued in Honolulu, Hawaii, America's 50th state. US # 1153

This stamp would be the first of many to picture the 50-star US flag.The US flag has become one of the most popular US stamp subjects, with new stamps being issued early every year.

LEA SENGHAAS & DORA ROBERTS (Info from Mystic Stamp Co.)

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
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Mailing Jack Virta

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SAPA meets at MacArthur Park Lutheran Church, 2903 Nacogdoches Rd, every Friday night at 7:30 pm in Bldg. #1, facing Nacogdoches Rd.
Yearly dues are $20.00, prorated.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	Chip Swinney
Vice President:	Al Lozano
Secretary:	Pat Richmond
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chairman:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chairman:	
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Chip Swinney
Assistant Auctioneer:	Steve Mabie

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	Chip Swinney
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	RIP Dr. Eric Shepard
One year term:	Lea Senghaas
Two year term:	Nancy Mabie
Parliamentarian:	Harry Greer
Honorary Board Member	Jack Virta

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee: Tony Bir (Chairman)

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Texas Philatelic Association:	
APS Circuit Books:	Steve Mabie

WE WELCOME VISITORS

Please view our website **sastamps.org** for information on our meeting schedules

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourses and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE :

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

While your purchases will be given to you during the auction, please wait until the end of the auction to pay for them. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks made out to S.A.P.A. are acceptable. Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES

July 8-9 - Houston TSDA, [NEW LOCATION] Hilton Garden Inn – Energy Corridor, 12245 Katy Freeway (I-10 and Dairy Ashford Exit), Houston, TX 77095 (Friday 10-5, Saturday 9-4)

July 30-31 - ARK-LA-TEX Coin, Stamp, and Card EXPO Bossier City Civic Center, 620 Benton Road (exit 20 off I-20) Bossier City, LA 71111. (Saturday 9-6, Sunday 9-3)

August 26-27 - DALLAS TSDA, Doubletree Hotel, Bluebonnet Room, 1981 North Central Expressway (Hwy 75 & Campbell Rd), Richardson, TX 75080 (Friday 10-5, Saturday 9-4)

TSDA - https://www.tsdastamps.com is the Texas Stamp Dealers Association's website. If you wish to attend any show listed for them in our newsletter, please check this site to make sure the show is going forward, and has not been cancelled for any reason.

Program Notes

July 22 - "What do we have stamps for if we are not using them on mail" by Fred Groth

Well, Fred that is a good question. Why Indeed? I would presume that you are going to tell us. Your programs in the past have given us a taste of 'non-postage-postage'!!! We will be interested in what you have 'dug-up' since then. Since I am of the 'snail-mail' generation, this situation of Non-postage-postage has me completely flustered. Here's hoping you will shed some light on my dilemma. Nevertheless, everyone will ready find out. The floor is yours, Fred.

Yours in Philately, Pat Richmond

SA&ST POSTCARD CLUB

The San Antonio and South Texas Postcard Club meets on the third Monday of each month. Our next three meetings will be held on July 18, August 15, and September 19. The postcard club is open to anyone who collects or is simply interested in postcards. The annual membership dues are $10.00.

Meetings are held at the Dwyer Center of the San Antonio Genealogical & Historical Society, 903 Melissa Drive. The Dwyer Center is on the corner of Blanco Road & Melissa Drive, about one mile outside Loop 410.

We start gathering at 6:30 to talk, buy, sell, and trade postcards. Our meetings start at 7:00 pm. Each meeting usually includes a short presentation by a member on some segment of his or her postcard collection.

For more information about the San Antonio and South Texas Postcard Club, contact the club secretary, Nancy Mabie, NRMabie@gmail.com.

If someone wants to receive email notifications when there is important information for club members, but does not want to have their email in the Philatex, please let Fred Groth know. He will make sure you keep informed, but will protect your privacy. Contact him at **LTC519@satx.rr.com** or phone him at 210-829-0323.

WELCOME NEW MEMBER

Jose Rivera #2880

FRED'S CORNER

From the APS, June 27, 2022

Postal Service Celebrates Mathematical Beauty of Flowers

The U.S. Postal Service has issued two high-denomination stamps celebrating the mathematical symmetry of flowers. The $2 and $5 Floral Geometry stamps are designed for packages, large envelopes and other mailings. The stamps were released on June 22, 2022 without a ceremony.

The natural world is full of patterns and beauties of form that inspire artists. The Floral Geometry stamp art began as an exploration of the patterns found in nature — specifically the symmetry of flowers.

The stamps' art features a series of overlapping geometric shapes — including circles, ovals and triangles — that reflect the symmetry of floral patterns found in nature in their simplest forms. For these two stamps, the designs become more complex as the denominations rise. The watercolor backgrounds were painted by hand and then scanned; the white geometric lines and typography were added digitally. The background for the $2 stamp is green, and the $5 stamp's background is purple. The stamps were printed with a foil treatment that adds an elegant glimmer.

The $2 Floral Geometry stamp will be issued in panes of 10 stamps, and the $5 Floral Geometry stamp will be issued in panes of four.

Al Lozano's Surprise Program

Al Lozano gave us a very interesting and informative talk about the history of the Army & Air Force Exchange Service (AAFES, also referred to as The Exchange, and The PX or The BX). It is the retailer in U.S. Army and Air Force installations worldwide. The Exchange is headquartered in Dallas, Texas. The oldest and largest of the Department's military exchange services, it is #53 on the National Retail Federations Top 100 Retailers list.

History - In the pre-Exchange days, Suttlers (Carpet Baggers) travelled from camp to camp selling their wares, mostly at inflated prices. Their existence goes back to the French Indian Wars, and the Revolutionary War.

In 1895, the War Department directed Post/Camp Commanders to open Exchanges at their Posts/Camps (U.S. only). By 1917, PXs served over 2 jillion soldiers in the U.S. Civilian agencies (contracted) had to meet the soldiers needs overseas. The first documented use of the term PX was in 1919 at Camp Mckinley, Philippines.

In 1941, the Army created the Army Exchange Service to assist with establishing and financing Exchanges throughout the world. During WWII, the Army Exchang operated thousands of exchanges around the world. By the end of 1944, there were 175 Army Exchanges in Europe. Two months after Japan's surrender, Army Exchanges were operating in Tokyo, Osaka, Yokohama, and throughout Japan.

On July 26, 1948, the Army Exchange Service was renamed the Army & Air Force Exchange Service, to reflect AES' responsibility to serve the Air Force, which was created in 1947. Now PX (Army) and BX (Air Force) names were used. From it's headquarters in Japan, the Army and Air Force Exchange supplied merchandise to soldiers fighting in Korea, somethimes delivering items by helicopter.

During the Vietnam War, AAFES operated more than 300 Major retail stores, and over 1,500 restaurants/snack Bars in Vietnam.There were also an additional 2,500 cconcessions (barbers/ tailors/ Massage parlors, etc.) At this point in time, the exchange was the #8 retailer in the world.

In 1990, AAFES operated 17 stores and 150 field exchanges supporting troops in Kuwait and Saudi Arabia. in the mid 1990s, they followed the military to the Balkands in support of the NATO mission. Operating facilities in Bosnia, Kosovo, Hungary and other European nations to support our troops. In 2001, Pogs were developed for use overseas as a lightweight currency to carry in combat zones. They are no longer in use.

Today's exchange operates retail stores, gas stations, food activities, theaters, Military Clothing stores, Class Vi(liquor stores), Bakery plants, ice cream plants, School Feeding Programs as well as telephone service and cable TV service. The Exchange contracts for Barber shops, beauty shops, nail salons, Laundry & Dry Cleaning, even Tax services and more.

Al also had a large collection of old camps, posts, and overseas postcards of Exchanges, including Army Officer's School(Princeton).

A very interesting collection, Al. Thank you for sharing it with us.

Lea Senghaas

George Garten & Dora Roberts get delicious food

Brother Ed Lock enjoys a good dessert

Rick Cross likes to read & feed

Nelda Greer, Dora Roberts & Chip Swinney

Pat Richmond, Adam Hays & Delbert Richmond

Tommy Bowen

Martha & Al Lozano

Chip Swinney, Lea Senghaas

Dora Roberts, Delbert Richmond

Michael Vogelsang & Friend

Nelda Greer

Arlen & Harry Greer

Jose Rivera

We finished off our picnic with a silent Auction!

Brittany Roberts, our photographer

We enjoyed being with our friends, and the BBQ and the sides and desserts that everyone brought were delicious!